

Chapter 15

Enjoy the Journey

“You are the sum total of everything you’ve ever seen, heard, eaten, smelled, been told, forgot—it’s all there. Everything influences each of us, and because of that I try to make sure that my experiences are positive.” –Maya Angelou

The conventional wisdom is that we need to work our entire adult lives so we can retire in our sixties or seventies. We’re told it’s difficult to obtain FI. Many people never do.

The FI community flips conventional wisdom on its head. It’s not uncommon for those in the FI community to achieve FI in only ten to fifteen years. Some do it in less than a decade. While this can be inspirational, it can also give the false impression that the path to FI is easy. It’s not.

Many on the path to FI, or those who have already achieved it, demonstrate a common pattern. We start off frustrated with the standard path through life, so we get excited about the idea of FIRE. We see a lack of money keeping us bound to jobs, which prevent us from living the lifestyles we desire. We become certain we’ll be